



CYBERSECURITY INTERNSHIP

Passive Reconnaissance & OSINT

Recon Report — Day 1 & Day 2 Task

Target Domain: tesla.com

Prepared by	Mah Noor
Role	Cybersecurity Intern
Task	Day 1–2: Passive Reconnaissance / OSINT
Attacker Machine	Kali Linux (mahnoor@kali)
Date Submitted	September 6, 2026

1. Objective

The goal of this task was to perform passive reconnaissance and open-source intelligence (OSINT) gathering against a public domain without directly interacting with or scanning its live infrastructure. This included WHOIS lookups, Google Dorking, and automated OSINT collection using theHarvester, followed by completion of four TryHackMe rooms covering the underlying techniques (Passive Reconnaissance, Google Dorking, OhSINT, and Shodan.io).

Target domain selected: tesla.com

Tesla's public domain was chosen as it is a large, well-known organization with a rich public footprint, making it well suited to demonstrate the range of passive OSINT techniques covered in this task, while all methods used (WHOIS, Google indexing, certificate transparency logs) are entirely passive and do not touch Tesla's live servers.

2. WHOIS Lookup

Command used:

```
whois tesla.com
```

Key findings from the WHOIS record:

- Registrar: MarkMonitor Inc. (IANA ID 292) — a registrar commonly used by large corporations for brand protection
- Domain created: November 4, 1992
- Registry expiry date: November 3, 2026
- Domain status: clientTransferProhibited, clientUpdateProhibited, clientDeleteProhibited (and server-side equivalents) — indicates strong protection against unauthorized transfers/hijacking
- Name servers: Akamai (A1-12.AKAM.NET, etc.) and UltraDNS (EDNS69.ULTRADNS.*) — shows use of enterprise-grade, redundant DNS/CDN infrastructure
- DNSSEC: unsigned
- Registrant organization/contact details are privacy-redacted, exposing only the registrar's abuse contact — a common practice for large brands to reduce exposure to spam and social engineering

```
(mahnoor@kali)-[~/Desktop]
$ whois tesla.com
Domain Name: TESLA.COM
Registry Domain ID: 187902_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN
Registrar WHOIS Server: whois.markmonitor.com
Registrar URL: http://www.markmonitor.com
Updated Date: 2024-10-02T10:15:20Z
Creation Date: 1992-11-04T05:00:00Z
Registry Expiry Date: 2026-11-03T05:00:00Z
Registrar: MarkMonitor Inc.
Registrar IANA ID: 292
Registrar Abuse Contact Email: abusecomplaints@markmonitor.com
Registrar Abuse Contact Phone: +1.2086851750
Domain Status: clientDeleteProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientDeleteProhibited
Domain Status: clientTransferProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientTransferProhibited
Domain Status: clientUpdateProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientUpdateProhibited
Domain Status: serverDeleteProhibited https://icann.org/epp#serverDeleteProhibited
Domain Status: serverTransferProhibited https://icann.org/epp#serverTransferProhibited
Domain Status: serverUpdateProhibited https://icann.org/epp#serverUpdateProhibited
Name Server: A1-12.AKAM.NET
Name Server: A10-67.AKAM.NET
Name Server: A12-64.AKAM.NET
Name Server: A28-65.AKAM.NET
Name Server: A7-66.AKAM.NET
Name Server: A9-67.AKAM.NET
Name Server: EDNS69.ULTRADNS.BIZ
Name Server: EDNS69.ULTRADNS.COM
Name Server: EDNS69.ULTRADNS.NET
Name Server: EDNS69.ULTRADNS.ORG
DNSSEC: unsigned
URL of the ICANN Whois Inaccuracy Complaint Form: https://www.icann.org/wicf/
>>> Last update of whois database: 2026-09-03T03:57:12Z <<<

For more information on Whois status codes, please visit https://icann.org/epp
```

Figure 1: whois tesla.com output

3. Google Dorking

Three Google dorks were used against the target domain to identify publicly indexed content:

3.1 site:tesla.com filetype:pdf

Purpose: locate publicly accessible PDF documents hosted on Tesla's domain.

Result: returned owner's manuals, warranty agreements, and order agreement PDFs — all intentionally published customer-facing documents, no sensitive internal files were exposed.

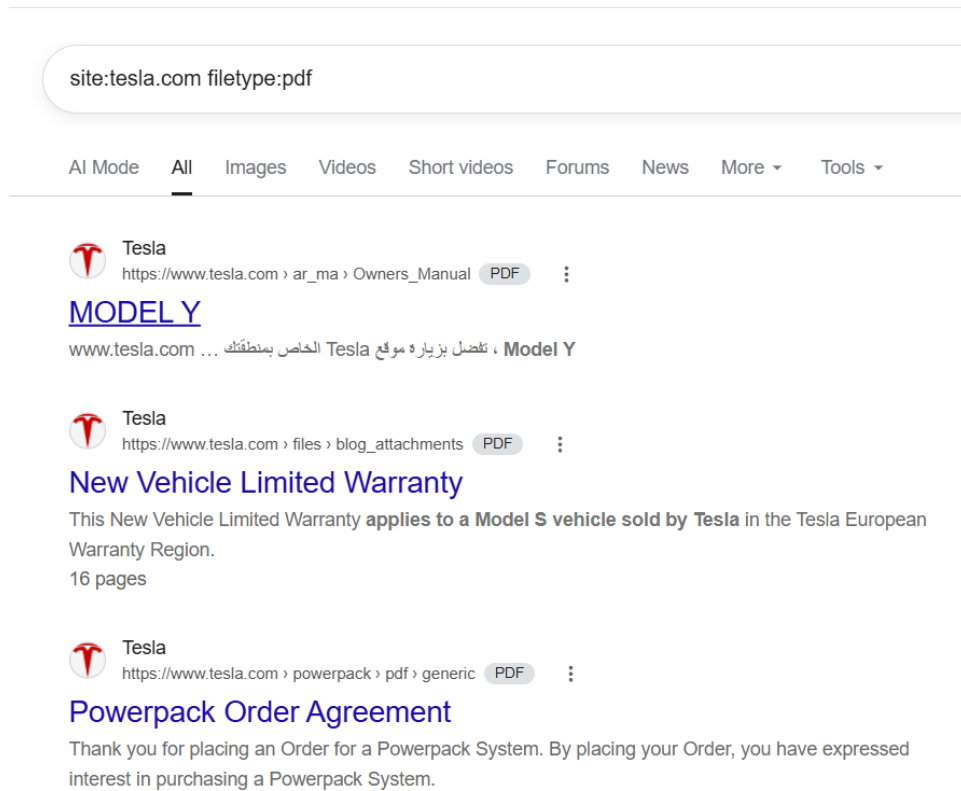


Figure 2: site:tesla.com filetype:pdf results

3.2 site:tesla.com inurl:login

Purpose: identify login-related pages indexed by Google.

Result: surfaced the Tesla account password-reset page and a reference to a login prompt inside the Model 3 owner's manual — expected, low-risk exposure of standard authentication entry points, nothing indicating a misconfigured or hidden admin panel.

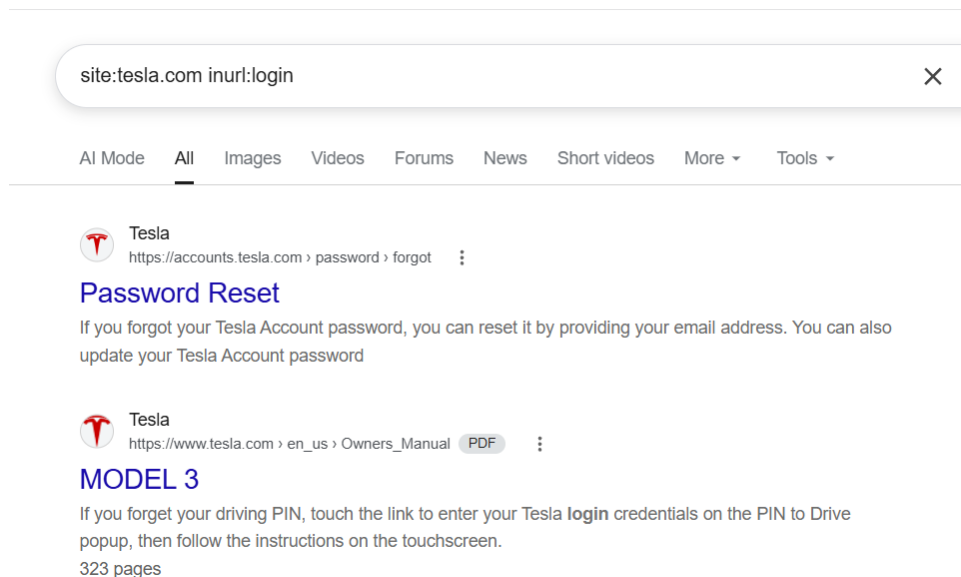


Figure 3: site:tesla.com inurl:login results

3.3 intitle:"index of" site:tesla.com

Purpose: search for exposed open directory listings, which often leak files never meant to be public.

Result: no results were returned for the exact phrase. This is a positive security finding — it indicates Tesla's web servers are not leaking open directory listings, unlike many smaller or misconfigured sites.

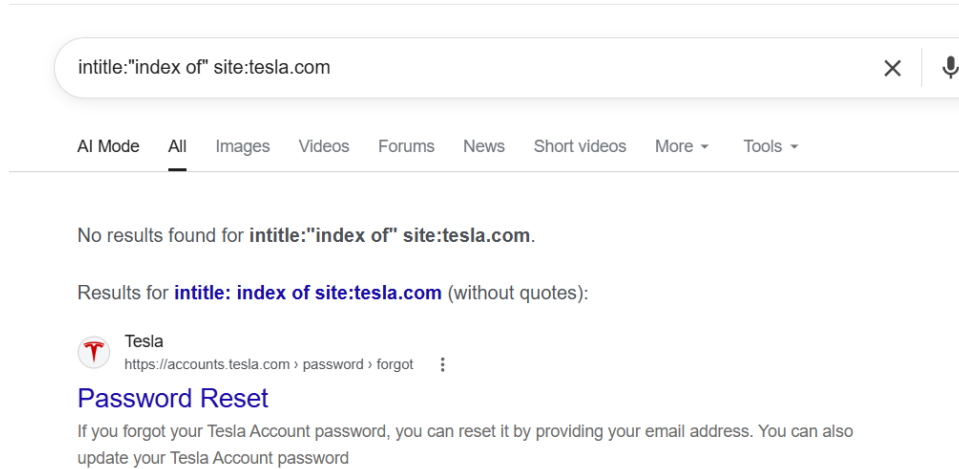


Figure 4: intitle:"index of" site:tesla.com — no results found

4. theHarvester — Subdomain & Email Enumeration

Command used:

```
theharvester -d tesla.com -b crtsh -l 200
```

theHarvester was pointed at crt.sh (certificate transparency logs) to passively enumerate subdomains without touching Tesla's servers directly.

- Hosts found: 326 subdomains, including *.cn.tesla.com, *.de.tesla.com, *.eu.logs.tesla.com, *.gf.tesla.com, *.logs.tesla.com, *.na.tesla.com, and *.nv.tesla.com
- No IPs, emails, or people were found via this source — consistent with a domain that does not expose personal or contact data through certificate metadata


```
(mahnoor@kali) - [~/Desktop]
$ theHarvester -d tesla.com -l 200 -b all
Read proxies.yaml from /etc/theHarvester/proxies.yaml
*****
*
* [ASCII ART]
*
* theHarvester 4.11.1
* Coded by Christian Martorella
* Edge-Security Research
* cmartorella@edge-security.com
*
*****

[*] Target: tesla.com

Read api-keys.yaml from /etc/theHarvester/api-keys.yaml
Failed to process bevigil search for word: 'tesla.com'
Error Message:
[!] Missing API key for bevigil.
Read api-keys.yaml from /etc/theHarvester/api-keys.yaml

[!] Missing API key for Bitbucket.
Read api-keys.yaml from /etc/theHarvester/api-keys.yaml
Failed to process bufferoverrun search for word: 'tesla.com'
Error Message:
[!] Missing API key for bufferoverrun.
Read api-keys.yaml from /etc/theHarvester/api-keys.yaml
Failed to perform BuiltWith search for word: 'tesla.com'
A Missing Key Error occurred in builtwith:
[!] Missing API key for BuiltWith.
```

Figure 6: theHarvester -b all — API-gated sources unavailable without keys

5. Bonus: Shodan Analysis

As additional practical depth beyond the core Day 1 requirements, Shodan.io was used to explore internet-wide exposure patterns for MySQL services under Google's autonomous system (ASN AS15169).

Query used: `asn:AS15169 product:mysql`

- Total exposed MySQL results: 1,145 hosts
- Top countries: United States (714), Netherlands (2nd most popular), Singapore (126)
- Operating system fingerprinting for these hosts returned no information — Google's cloud-hosted MySQL instances do not leak OS banner data to Shodan, indicating hardened service banners

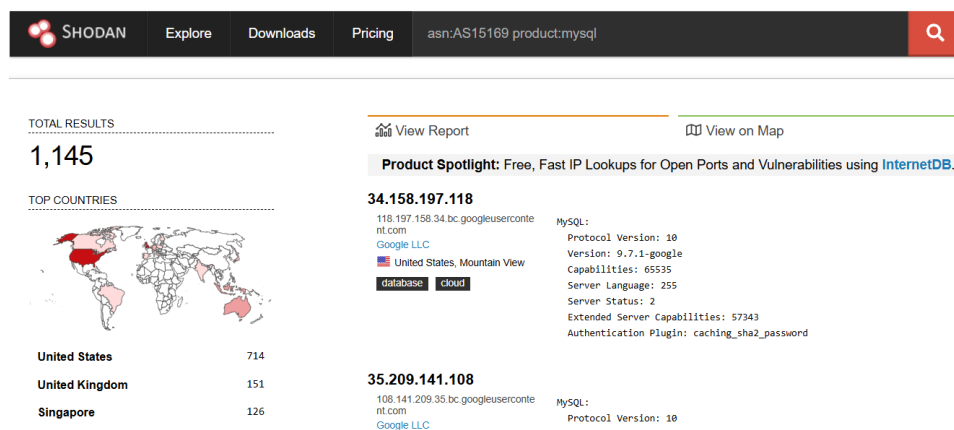


Figure 7: Shodan results for `asn:AS15169 product:mysql`

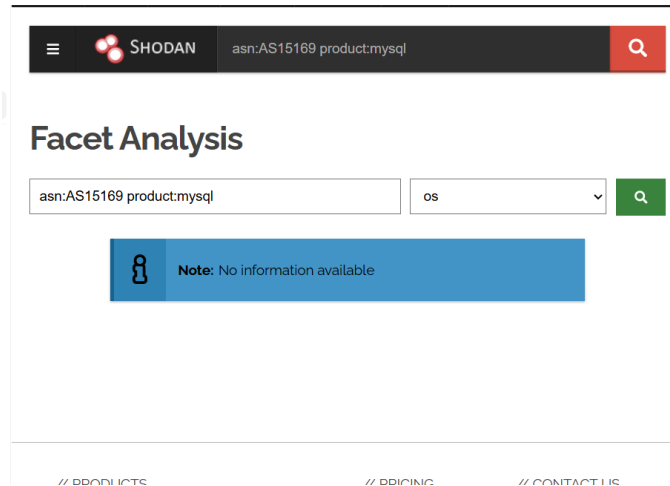


Figure 8: OS facet analysis returning no information — a hardening indicator

6. TryHackMe Room Completions (Proof)

All four compulsory free-tier TryHackMe rooms listed in the task were completed:

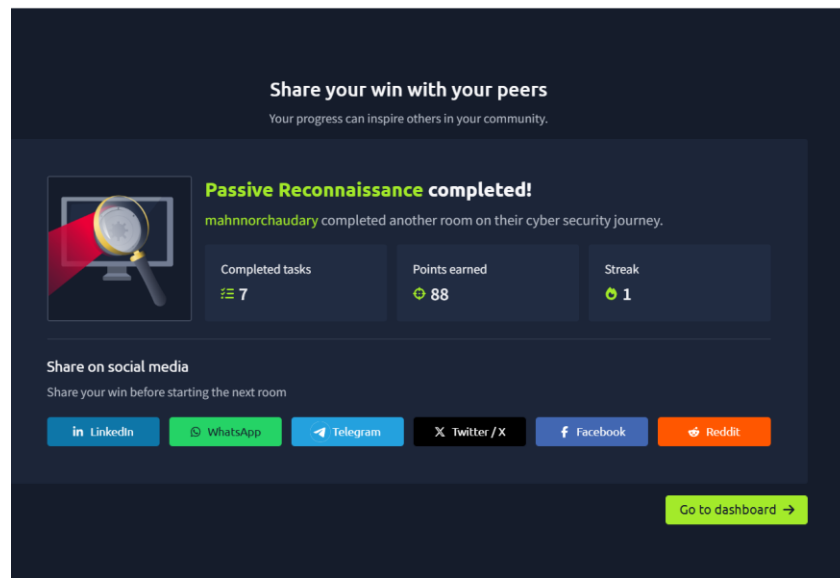


Figure 9: Passive Reconnaissance — completed (7 tasks, 88 points)

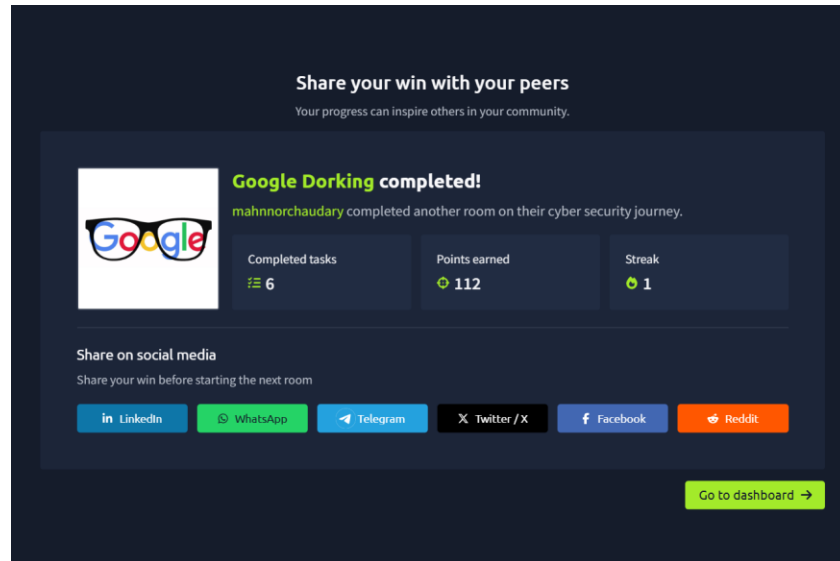


Figure 10: Google Dorking — completed (6 tasks, 112 points)

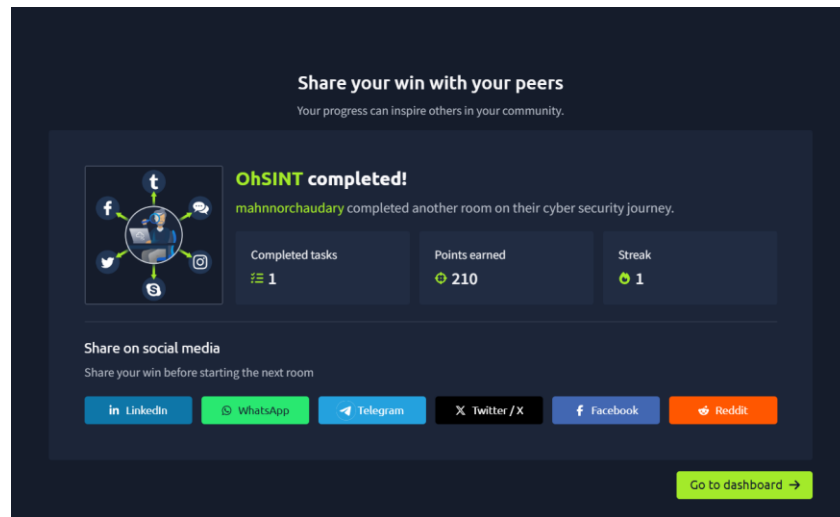


Figure 11: OhSINT — completed (1 task, 210 points)

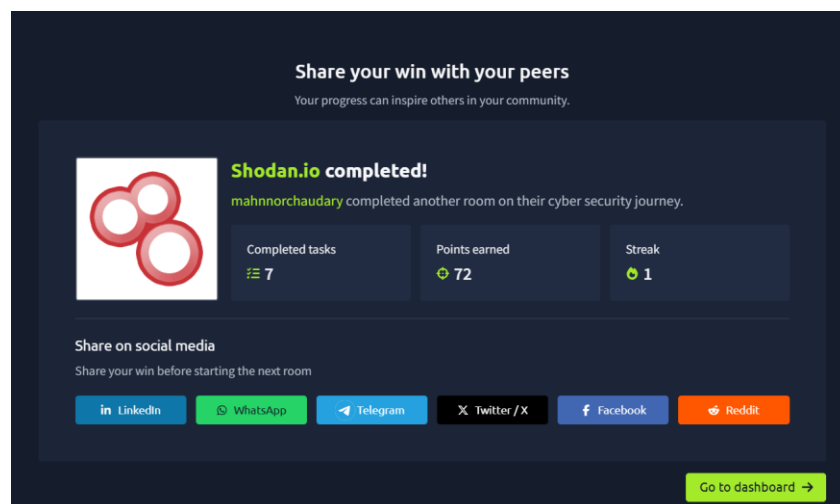


Figure 12: Shodan.io — completed (7 tasks, 72 points)

7. Recon Notes Summary

Target	tesla.com
Registrar	MarkMonitor Inc.
Domain Created	1992-11-04
Domain Expires	2026-11-03
Name Servers	Akamai, UltraDNS
Google Dorks Used	filetype:pdf, inurl:login, intitle:"index of"
Subdomains Found (theHarvester)	326 (via crt.sh)
Emails / People Found	None
Open Directory Listings	None found (good security posture)

8. Conclusion

This exercise demonstrated that a substantial amount of information about a target organization can be gathered entirely passively — without ever sending a packet to the target's own infrastructure. WHOIS revealed registration and DNS provider details; Google Dorking surfaced publicly indexed documents and login endpoints while confirming the absence of exposed directory listings; and theHarvester's use of certificate transparency logs mapped out 326 subdomains under tesla.com. Extending this with a brief Shodan lookup showed how the same passive mindset scales to internet-wide infrastructure analysis. Overall, tesla.com showed a mature security posture with no obvious sensitive data leakage through the passive channels tested.